ENS3553/6160 Lab Reports Marking Scheme

You are required to write a laboratory report detailing the work you completed in the laboratory sessions.

This report will follow a standard scientific report structure:

1. **Title page**
2. **Abstract (200-400 words)**
3. **Table of Contents**
4. **Introduction**
5. **Method**
6. **Results**
7. **Discussion**
8. **Conclusion (approximately 200 words)**
9. **References**

CRITERIA	High Distinction (80-100)	Distinction (70-79)	Credit (60-69)	Pass (50-59)	Fail (0-49)
Abstract: 5%	Clear, concise, and thorough summary, including motivation, aim, method, results, and implications of results.	Clear summary, including motivation, aim, method, results, and implications of results.	Acceptable summary of main parts of report. Missing one or two structural elements (motivation, aim, method, results, implication of results).	Attempted summary. May be unclear in parts or missing some elements, but it is possible to understand focus of report.	Unclear and incomplete summary of report. Missing substantial elements.
Introduction: 10%	Highly effective and cohesive context and motivation for work. Thorough and relevant background theory and literature presented to support motivation. Clear purpose/aim of work stated at end.	Established clear context and motivation for work, supported by relevant background theory and literature. Clear purpose/aim of work stated at the end.	Context and motivation of work established, with some supporting theory and literature. Purpose/aim stated at the end.	Attempt to establish context and motivation. Some background theory and literature included but links may be unclear in parts. Purpose/aim stated at the end.	Context and motivation unclear. Background theory and literature missing or irrelevant. Purpose/aim missing or unclear.
Method: 20%	Clear, concise, and thorough description of method, in adequate detail to ensure repetition, including the use of any equations. Assumptions stated and supported with highly relevant research.	Clear description of method, with adequate detail to ensure repetition, including the use of any equations. Assumptions stated and supported with research.	Method described, with mostly adequate detail to ensure repetition. Assumptions stated and supported.	Method described, but may have some elements missing. Assumptions stated with some attempt to explain or support with research.	Inadequate method described, with substantive missing details. Assumptions not stated, or no clear reasoning presented.
Results: 20%	All relevant data presented in a logical and cohesive manner. Excellent use of tables and figures which are all correctly captioned and mentioned in the text.	All relevant data presented with good use of tables and figures. All elements correctly captioned and mentioned in the text.	All relevant data presented, with mostly effective use of tables and figures. All elements correctly captioned and mentioned in the text.	Most data presented, with captions. Some captions may be incorrect. Attempt to mention some data in text, may be incomplete.	Substantial data missing or presentation is unclear. Missing captions and not explicitly mentioned in text.
Discussion: 20%	Logical and insightful analysis and interpretation of the results for all three options. Demonstrates excellent understanding of concepts, and forms appropriate conclusions based on interpretation, strongly supported by reference to theory, literature, and real-world applications. Includes thoughtful and thorough discussion of any limitations or challenges.	Thoughtful analysis and interpretation or results for all three options. Good understanding of concepts demonstrated, with appropriate conclusions formed based on interpretation, and relevant reference to theory, literature, and real-world applications. Includes adequate discussion of any limitations or challenges.	Analysis and interpretation for all three options. Clear understanding of concepts with relevant conclusions made based on interpretation. Mostly effective links made to theory, literature, or real-world applications. Includes discussion of any limitations or challenges.	Some analysis and interpretation for at least two options. Some understanding of concepts apparent in conclusions drawn from interpretation, with some links made to theory, literature, or real-world applications. Limited discussion of limitations or challenges.	Analysis and interpretation missing or illogical, with limited understanding apparent. Missing or irrelevant conclusions and references to theory, literature, or real-world applications. No attempt to discuss limitations or challenges.
Conclusion: 5%	Clear, concise, and thorough summary, including aim, main findings, and limitations with insightful summary of results in relation to theory and their broader implications.	Clear summary, including aim, main findings, and limitations, with good summary of results in relation to theory and their broader implications.	Acceptable summary of aim, main findings, and limitations. Makes link between results, theory, and broader implications, but may be limited.	Attempted summary. May be unclear in parts or missing some elements, but it is possible to understand main findings of the report.	Unclear and incomplete summary of report. Missing substantial elements.

Written Skills: **15%** Language, style, layout and logical flow	Uses a wide-range of highly appropriate vocabulary and discipline-specific terms. Writing style is highly appropriate for technical audience with a focus on clear, concise, and precise language. Error-free spelling, punctuation, and grammar. Correct tenses used throughout.	Uses a range of appropriate and accurate discipline-specific vocabulary. Style and structure are appropriate for a technical audience. Clear, concise and cohesive expressions with logical flow. Occasional errors in spelling, punctuation, and grammar. Correct tenses used throughout.	Uses vocabulary and discipline-specific terms accurately. Style and structure are mostly appropriate. Reasonably well expressed and clearly flows. Infrequent errors in spelling and punctuation which do not impede understanding. Tense use mostly correct.	Uses mostly appropriate vocabulary and key discipline-specific terms. Basic organisation and style. Logical flow, not expressed as well as could be. Errors in spelling, punctuation and/ or grammar occasionally impede understanding. Tense use often incorrect, but does not impede understanding.	Uses limited vocabulary or inappropriate word choices; discipline-specific terms are misused or missing. Style and /or structure is inappropriate. Lacks flow and may be difficult to follow. Errors in grammar, spelling and / or punctuation interfere with understanding. No clear use of different tenses.
Referencing: **5%**	Citing and referencing in APA style is accurate throughout.	Citing and referencing is generally appropriate and accurate.	Some errors in citing and referencing may persist.	Citing and referencing is attempted, but with errors.	Referencing is consistently inaccurate or not attempted.